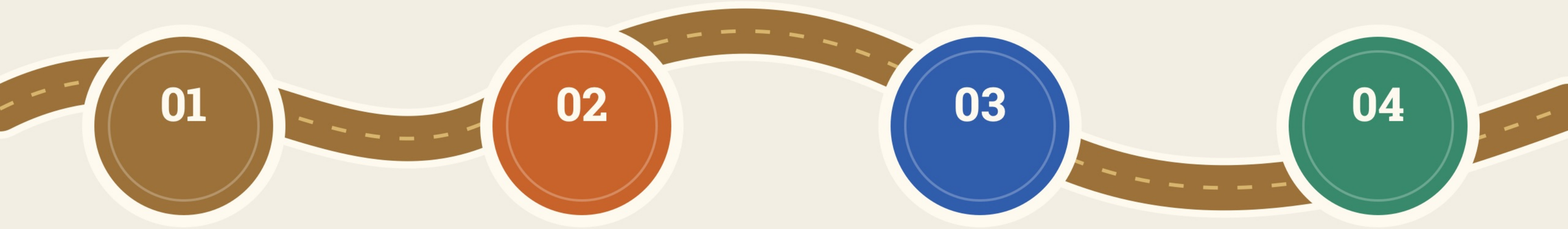
FROM BILL TO LAW

A bill is a proposal for a law. Follow the decisions that can turn it into national policy.



COMMITTEES

Hearings and markup can change a bill. Many bills stop here.

HOUSE AND SENATE

House rules limit debate. A Senate **FILIBUSTER** can delay a vote.

SAME TEXT

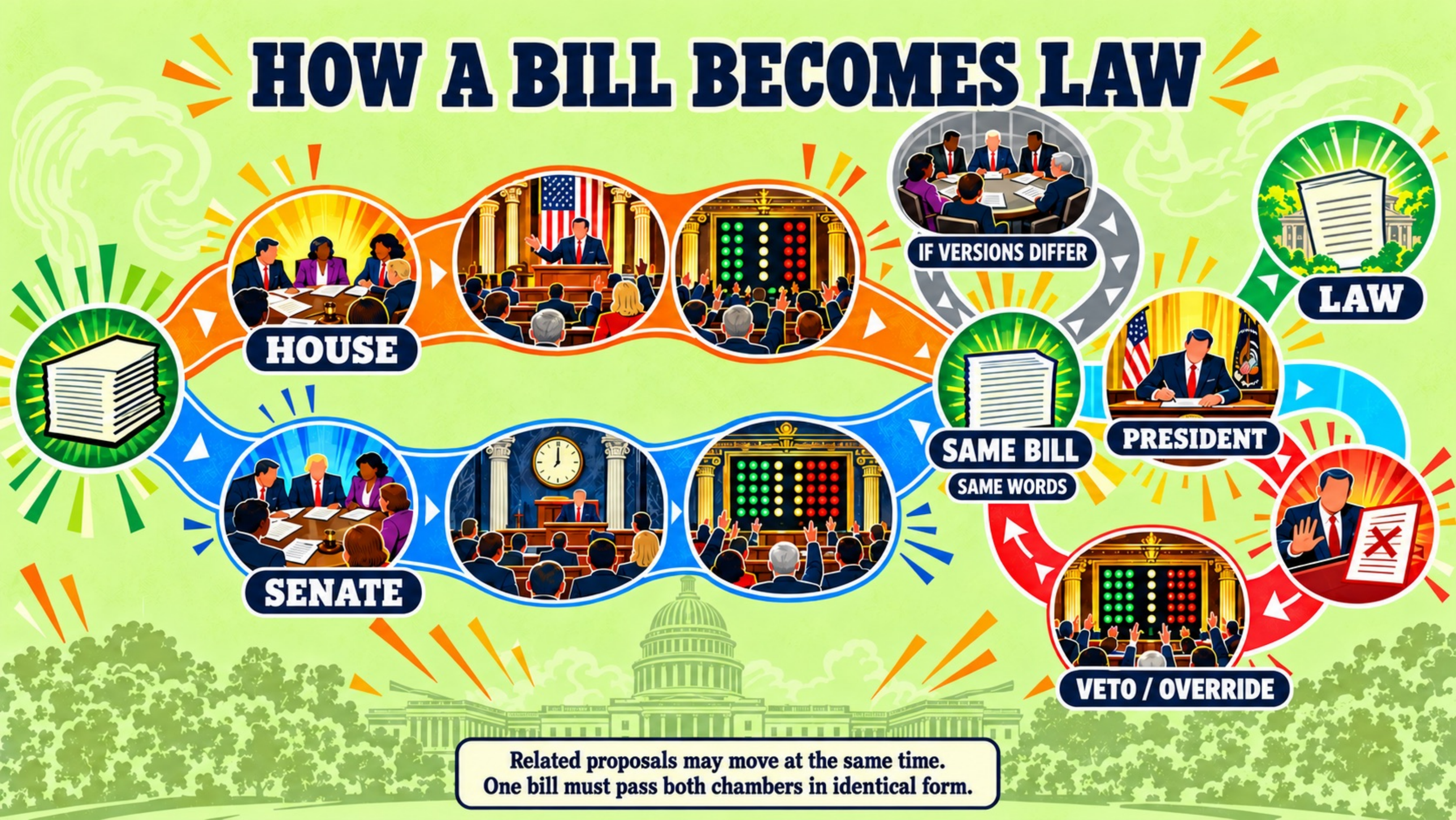
Both chambers must pass the same bill in identical form.

PRESIDENT

The President signs or vetoes. Congress can override a veto.

Where could this proposal be delayed, changed, or stopped?

HOW A BILL BECOMES LAW



Related proposals may move at the same time.
One bill must pass both chambers in identical form.

BILL INTRODUCED



HOUSE COMMITTEE

STANDING COMMITTEE

A permanent group handles bills in one policy area.



HEARING

Members question witnesses to learn about the issue.



MARKUP

Members debate wording and vote on changes to the bill.



CHAIR

The majority party picks the chair. Many bills stop here.



HOUSE FLOOR

AGENDA

The Speaker and majority party decide which bills get time.



RULES COMMITTEE

Sets the terms for debate and which changes may be offered.



DEBATE

The full House discusses the bill and may change it.



VOTE

Representatives decide whether the House passes it.



SENATE COMMITTEE

STANDING COMMITTEE

Senators study bills in a particular policy area.



HEARING

Members question witnesses to learn about a bill.



MARKUP

Members debate wording and vote on revisions.



COMMITTEE CHAIR

The majority party picks the chair. Many bills stop here.



SENATE FLOOR

HOLD
A senator may object when leaders seek unanimous consent to bring up a bill.



FILIBUSTER
Extended debate can delay or prevent a vote.



CLOTURE
Usually 60 votes are needed to limit debate on a bill.



VOTE
If debate ends, senators vote on whether the bill passes.



CONFERENCE COMMITTEE

TWO VERSIONS
The House and Senate may pass different wording.

WORK IT OUT
Members from both chambers negotiate one version.

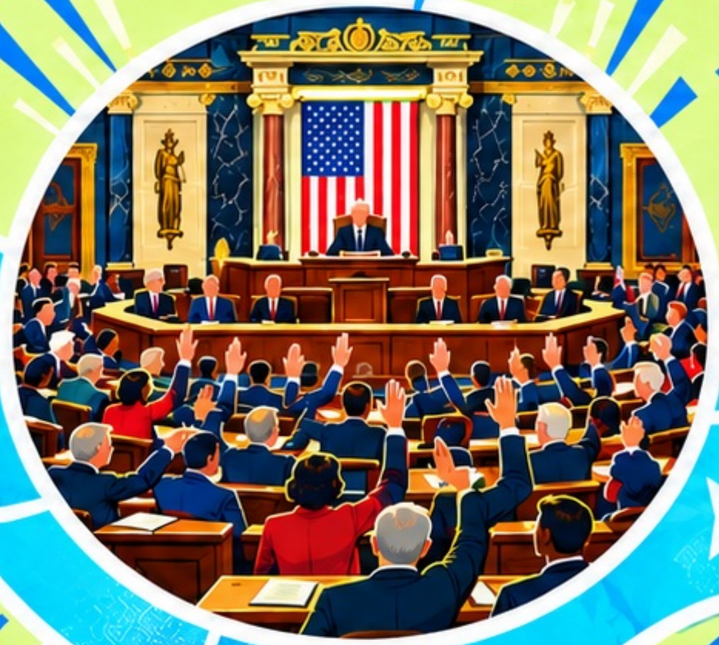
BACK TO BOTH
The agreed text returns to the House and Senate.



SAME BILL. SAME WORDS.

HOUSE
Votes on the final version.





SENATE
Votes on that same version.



TO THE PRESIDENT
Only after both chambers approve identical text.



PRESIDENTIAL ACTION

SIGN
The President can sign the bill into law.



VETO
The President can reject the bill.





OVERRIDE
Two-thirds in each chamber must vote to override a veto.





